

THE
LICINA
FAMILY RECIPE COLLECTION



*Recipes gathered with love, from Tatjana's kitchen — to the kitchens of
future generations of Licinas*

About This Collection

My beautiful daughters Natasha and Bianca asked me to write a recipe book of all their favourite meals they enjoyed as children and continue to enjoy as young adults. This collection includes those recipes and a collection of my own favourites from talented chefs and my own creations.

For me, cooking has always been an expression of my creativity and my kitchen a space for relaxation. Preparing and serving food for my family and friends is how I stay socially connected and show love. My husband motivates and encourages my passion for cooking; often joining me in designing menus, sourcing ingredients and preparing dinners for social occasions with our friends and family.

How Recipes Are Tagged

- Family Favourite — dishes from Natasha and Bianca's childhood
- Tanya's Collection — recipes gathered from my cookbook library, credited to the original author
- Tanya's Original — my own creations

RECIPE 1

Roast Chicken with Zucchini Stuffing

Poulet Rôti Farci aux Courgettes

Tanya's Collection — adapted from Diane Holuigue, Savouring Provence

Ingredients

- 2–3 zucchini, finely grated (2 cups)
- 2 spring onions, sliced
- 2 tbsp fresh breadcrumbs
- 2 tbsp grated parmesan
- 1 tbsp chopped oregano
- 1 tsp chopped thyme
- Salt and pepper
- 1 whole chicken (~2kg)
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- Optional jus: 1 cup chicken stock, splash of sherry or Madeira, touch of tomato paste

Method

Mix the zucchini, spring onion, breadcrumbs, parmesan, and herbs into a stuffing. Loosen the chicken's skin from the breast without tearing it, then pack the stuffing into that pocket so it bastes the meat as it roasts.

Truss, oil, and season the outside, then roast at 220°C for about 1¼ hours until the thigh juices run clear (or the thigh reaches 82°C internally). Rest for 10–15 minutes before carving into quarters.

For the jus, deglaze the roasting pan with stock, reduce, and adjust with tomato paste or sherry if needed.

ROAST CHICKEN WITH ZUCCHINI STUFFING

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RECIPE 2

Sour Cherry Pita

Pita s Višnjama

Family Favourite — Serbian heritage — from Veliki Narodni Kuvar ("The Great Folk Cookbook"), translated from the original Cyrillic

Ingredients

- 1 tbsp lard or butter
- 2 egg yolks (plus 1 extra for glazing)
- 4–5 tbsp sugar
- Juice of 1 lemon
- 5 tbsp milk
- ½ packet baking powder
- 2 egg whites, stiffly whipped
- Flour, as needed, to form a soft dough
- Sour cherries, cleaned/pitted
- Ground walnuts
- Fine sugar, for the filling and dusting

Method

Rinse the lard or butter, then whip until fluffy. Beat in the egg yolks, sugar, lemon juice, milk, and baking powder. Fold in the stiffly whipped egg whites. Add just enough flour to form a dough that isn't too firm, then roll into two sheets sized to fit your baking tray.

Grease the tray and dust with flour. Lay down the first sheet of dough, scatter over the cherries, then top with ground walnuts and a little fine sugar. Cover with the second sheet, brush the top with egg yolk, and bake in a fairly hot oven. Cut into squares once baked and dust with sugar to serve. Keeps well for several days — reportedly even better with time.

SOUR CHERRY PITA

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RECIPE 3

Vanilice

Vanilla Sandwich Cookies

Family Favourite — Serbian heritage — from Veliki Narodni Kuvar ("The Great Folk Cookbook"), translated from the original Cyrillic

Ingredients

- 250g butter (or 200g lard)
- ½ kg flour
- 1 egg yolk, plus 1 whole egg
- 4 tbsp sugar
- Juice of 1 lemon
- 2 egg whites, whipped to a stiff foam (for coating)
- Finely chopped walnuts, for coating
- Jam (pekmez), for filling
- Vanilla sugar, for dusting

Method

Whip the butter or lard until fluffy, then beat in the egg yolk, whole egg, sugar, and lemon juice. Add the flour, turn the mixture out onto a pastry board, and knead into a dough. Roll it out to about half a centimetre thick.

Using a vanilice cutter, cut out small rounds. Dip each one into the whipped egg white foam, then sprinkle with finely chopped walnuts. Arrange on a greased tray and bake, taking care that they stay pale and don't brown. Once baked, spread with jam and sandwich two together. Dust with vanilla sugar and serve.

VANILICE

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RECIPE 4

Suve Kiflice od Orah

Dry Walnut Crescents

Family Favourite — Serbian heritage — from Veliki Narodni Kuvar ("The Great Folk Cookbook"), translated from the original Cyrillic

Ingredients

- ½ kg walnuts, ground
- 1 kg fine sugar
- 14 egg whites, divided (12 for the base mixture, 2 added after cooling)
- Zest of ½ lemon
- Extra chopped walnuts, for coating
- Flour, for the board

Method

Grind the walnuts and place them in a pot with the sugar, egg whites, and lemon zest. Mix together and warm gently on the stove — just enough to dissolve the sugar into the mixture, without letting it boil. Remove from the heat and transfer to another dish to cool.

Once cooled, mix in the remaining 2 egg whites. Turn the dough out onto a floured board and work it until it no longer sticks to your hands. Shape into rolls about 10cm long, curve each into a crescent shape, sprinkle generously with chopped walnuts, and bake on low heat so they stay pale.

SUVE KIFLICE OD ORAHA

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RECIPE 5

Lamb Racks with Breadcrumbs, Parsley and Lemon

Family Favourite — adapted from Bill Granger, bills open kitchen

Ingredients

- 3 thick slices wholemeal or sourdough bread
- 7g (¼ cup) finely chopped flat-leaf parsley
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- 1 garlic clove, crushed
- 60ml (¼ cup) olive oil, plus extra
- Sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
- 2 x 8 French-trimmed lamb racks
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 500g cherry tomatoes on the vine
- 4 garlic cloves, unpeeled (optional)

Method

Toast the bread until lightly golden, then crumble or process into breadcrumbs. Combine with the parsley, lemon zest, crushed garlic, olive oil, salt, and pepper.

Rub the lamb racks with a little extra olive oil and season well. Sear fat-side down in a hot pan for 2 minutes, then transfer to a baking tray. Spread the top of each rack with mustard and press on the breadcrumb mixture. Roast alongside the cherry tomatoes and whole garlic cloves at 180°C for 25–30 minutes, until the lamb is cooked and still pink inside. Rest, loosely covered in foil, for 5 minutes. Cut each rack in half and serve with the roasted tomatoes and garlic.

LAMB RACKS WITH BREADCRUMBS, PARSLEY AND LEMON

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RECIPE 6

Chicken Forestière with Mustard Cream

Tanya's Original

Ingredients

- 4 chicken breasts (skin-on preferred, skinless OK)
- plain flour, for coating
- 2 rashers bacon, chopped
- 100g small mushrooms, sliced
- 2 cloves garlic, finely chopped
- 2 stalks green shallots, chopped
- 30g butter
- 1 cup white wine
- 300ml whipping cream
- 1 tbsp Dijon mustard
- salt and pepper, to taste

Method

Heat the oven to 180°C.

Coat the chicken breasts in plain flour, shaking off the excess. Melt the butter in a wide cast iron pan over medium heat and sear the breasts until they are a golden colour on both sides. Halfway through the searing, add the chopped garlic and let it stick to both sides of the chicken — keep an eye on it, as the garlic shouldn't be allowed to burn.

Lift the chicken out of the pan into an ovenproof dish and bake for 20 minutes.

Meanwhile, fry the bacon and mushrooms in the same cast iron pan. Return the chicken to the pan and add the wine, letting it reduce by half, then stir through the cream and Dijon mustard. Season with salt and pepper to taste.

Let the sauce thicken for a few minutes, and add the green shallots just before serving so they stay fresh and green.

Serve with mashed potatoes and green beans.



RECIPE 7

Black Pepper Beef

Tanya's Collection — adapted from Adam Liaw, Asian After Work

Ingredients

- 500g beef rump, topside or Scotch fillet, thinly sliced
- 3–4 tbsp peanut oil, or other vegetable oil
- 2 garlic cloves, peeled and roughly chopped
- 1 tsp grated ginger
- 1 medium brown onion, peeled and sliced
- 1 green capsicum, deseeded and thinly sliced
- Cooked rice, to serve

Method

Mix the sliced beef with the marinade ingredients and set aside. Mix the black pepper paste ingredients in a separate bowl and set aside.

Heat a wok over high heat and pour 2 tbsp of the oil around the edges. Fry the beef in batches until browned but not quite cooked through, then remove from the wok and set aside.

Add the remaining oil to the wok, then the garlic and ginger, and fry over high heat for about 30 seconds, until the garlic is starting to colour. Add the onion and capsicum and stir-fry for 2 minutes, until softened, then remove the vegetables and set aside.

Return the wok to high heat and add the beef along with any collected juices. Spoon in the black pepper paste and toss the beef for 2–3 minutes, until well coated and the paste is starting to caramelise. Return the vegetables to the wok, toss until well combined, and serve with rice.

This recipe has a surprising amount of heat from the black pepper. For a milder version, reduce the amount of pepper in the paste and grind a little over at the end for flavour and aroma. Also works well with pork or chicken.

BLACK PEPPER BEEF

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Serbian Chestnut Torte

Kolač od Kestena

Tanya's Collection — Serbian heritage — from Veliki Narodni Kuvar, translated from the original Cyrillic

Ingredients

- 8 eggs, separated
- 1 tsp vanilla essence
- 300g sweetened chestnut puree
- 1 tbsp plain biscuit crumbs
- 2 tsp rum
- Filling: 500g sweetened chestnut puree, 1 tsp vanilla essence, ½ tsp rum, 3 tbsp cream, 50g unsalted butter
- Topping: 125g dark cooking chocolate, 70g butter

Method

Beat the egg yolks with the vanilla essence until they form a thick foam. Soak the biscuit crumbs in the rum, then add them to the yolks along with the chestnut puree. Beat the egg whites to stiff peaks and fold them through the mixture.

Line two identical round tins with baking paper and divide the mixture evenly between them. Bake at 170°C for 20–25 minutes, then remove from the oven and allow to cool to room temperature.

For the filling, whisk the chestnut puree, vanilla essence, rum, cream, and butter until smooth. Spread over one cake base, place the second cake on top, and refrigerate for 30 minutes to firm up before the topping goes on.

Melt the chocolate and butter together in a small saucepan over low heat until glossy and smooth. Pour over the top of the cake and return to the refrigerator to cool completely.

To make small cakes from this recipe, use rectangular tins and cut into small squares.



Choc Banana Bread

Tanya's Collection — adapted from Bill Granger, Bill's Food

Ingredients

- 250g (2 cups) plain flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 125g unsalted butter, softened
- 125g caster sugar
- 4 ripe bananas, mashed
- 2 eggs, lightly beaten
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 175g (1 cup) good-quality dark or milk chocolate chips
- 70g walnuts, chopped

Method

Preheat the oven to 180°C. Sift the flour and baking powder into a large bowl.

In a separate bowl, mix the butter, sugar, banana, eggs, vanilla, chocolate chips and walnuts. Add to the dry ingredients and stir just to combine — a loose mixture keeps the loaf moist, so be careful not to overmix.

Pour the batter into a non-stick, or lightly greased and floured, 19 x 11cm loaf tin and bake for 1 hour 15 minutes, until a skewer comes out clean. Leave to cool in the tin for 5 minutes before turning out onto a wire rack. Serve in thick slices with butter. Makes 8 to 10 slices.



Mushroom Sauce

Tanya's Collection — adapted from Nagi Maehashi, RecipeTin Eats

Ingredients

- 1 tbsp unsalted butter
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 150g mushrooms, sliced (morels are lovely here)
- Pinch of salt and pepper
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- 30ml dry white wine or rosé
- 60ml (¼ cup) chicken or vegetable broth
- 125ml (½ cup) thickened cream
- 30g parmesan, finely grated
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves (or ¼-½ tsp dried)

Method

Heat the oil and melt the butter in a skillet over medium-high heat. Add the mushrooms and let them cook unhurried until golden brown, about 4-5 minutes — no need to stir constantly. Just before they're done, add the garlic with a pinch of salt and pepper and cook for a minute more, until the garlic turns golden.

Pour in the wine — it will sizzle. Stir and scrape the bottom of the pan for a minute, until it has mostly evaporated. Add the broth, cream and parmesan, then lower the heat to a gentle simmer; don't let it boil hard or the cream may split.

Stir occasionally and simmer for 2-3 minutes, until it thickens a little — it shouldn't be heavy, this is a rich sauce. Stir through the thyme, taste for salt and pepper, and take it off the heat. Serve over chicken breasts or eye fillet, or toss it through pasta. Enough for two.

MUSHROOM SAUCE

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Moist Blueberry Muffins

Tanya's Collection — adapted from Nagi Maehashi, RecipeTin Eats

Ingredients

- 375g plain flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp bicarb soda (or an extra 3 tsp baking powder)
- 220g caster sugar
- ¼ tsp salt
- 250ml buttermilk (or full-cream milk with 1 tsp white vinegar stirred in, left to stand 5 minutes until curdled)
- 60g unsalted butter, melted
- 65ml vegetable oil
- 2 large eggs, at room temperature, lightly whisked
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 250g blueberries (frozen are fine — don't thaw them, or they bleed into the batter)

Method

Preheat the oven to 200°C and line a 12-hole muffin tin with paper cases.

Whisk the flour, baking powder, bicarb, sugar and salt together in a large bowl. In a second bowl, whisk the buttermilk, melted butter, oil, eggs and vanilla. Make a well in the dry ingredients, pour in the wet, and mix until only just combined — try not to stir more than eight times. A few lumps of flour are exactly right; overmixing is what makes muffins tough.

Fold through most of the blueberries, keeping a handful back. Divide the batter between the paper cases and scatter the reserved berries over the tops.

Bake for 5 minutes, then turn the oven down to 180°C and bake a further 13 minutes (fan) or 15 minutes (standard), until a skewer comes out clean. Lift them straight out of the tin onto a cooling rack. Best served warm. Makes 12.



Old-Fashioned Crescent Cookies with Jam

Starinske Kiflice sa Džemom

Tanya's Collection — adapted from Ivana Lalicki, Serbian Cookbook: Recipes and Stories from Serbia

Ingredients

- 225 g unsalted butter, softened
- 200 g sour cream
- A pinch of salt
- 1 tbsp granulated sugar
- 1 tbsp vanilla sugar
- 1 tbsp lemon zest
- 1 egg
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract
- 520 g plain flour, plus extra for dusting
- 150 g apricot or plum jam
- 250 g icing sugar, for coating
- 1 tsp vanilla sugar, for coating

Method

Makes about 36. Beat the softened butter, sour cream, salt, granulated sugar, vanilla sugar and lemon zest together with an electric mixer until creamy and fluffy. Add the egg and vanilla extract, then the flour, mixing only until it comes together. Divide the dough into three even portions and shape each one into a disc.

Heat the oven to 180°C and line two large trays with baking paper. On a well-floured surface, roll each disc out into a circle about 23 cm across and cut it into 12 even triangles. Place a teaspoon of jam at the wide base of each triangle, roll it up from the base, and set it on the tray with the point tucked underneath.

Bake for 15–20 minutes, until lightly golden on the bottom. Lift them onto a cooling rack and repeat with the remaining dough. Once cool, toss them in the icing sugar mixed with the vanilla sugar. They keep in a sealed container for up to a week.

Tip — do not refrigerate the dough. It will result in a much softer biscuit when baked, and less dry.

Tip — homemade apricot or plum jam makes the best filling.

OLD-FASHIONED CRESCENT COOKIES WITH JAM

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